18.1 Generalized Anxiety Disorder

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I worry about everything all the time." • "I cannot relax." **Objective** • Restless, muscles tense • HR 100/min • Finds it hard to concentrate during the interview	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to persistent excessive worry as evidenced by restlessness, muscle tension and poor concentration.	Within 1 week, can name two things that trigger her anxiety and uses one relaxation technique.	• Build trust with her; keep your manner calm and clear. • Help her spot her triggers and the first signs that anxiety is building. • Teach slow breathing and progressive muscle relaxation. • Give medication as prescribed and watch how it works. • Refer for psychological therapy (CBT, for example).	Uses the technique and says she is less anxious: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I lie awake thinking." **Objective** • Sleeps 4 hours a night • Tired	**ACTUAL** **Insomnia** related to anxious thoughts as evidenced by difficulty falling asleep and fatigue.	Sleeps at least 6 hours.	• Teach good sleep habits: regular bedtimes, no caffeine after the afternoon, no screens before bed. • Teach a relaxation routine for bedtime. • No naps in the day.	Sleeping better: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Only coffee and cigarettes calm me." **Objective** • Smoking more and drinking more caffeine	**RISK** **Risk for ineffective health self-management** as evidenced by risk factors: use of caffeine and nicotine to manage anxiety.	Can name healthier ways of coping.	• Talk about how caffeine and nicotine make anxiety worse. • Support her plan to cut down. • Encourage regular physical activity.	Coping in healthier ways: **goal met**.